



# ISBNPA

Advancing Behavior Change Science

**AUCKLAND, NEW ZEALAND**

**11 - 14 JUNE, 2025**





# Effectiveness of local government actions targeting physical activity, sedentary behaviour and dietary behaviour: a scoping review

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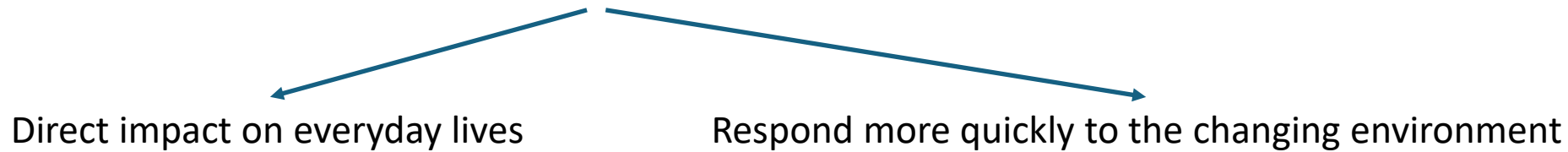
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# BACKGROUND



Growing interest from local government jurisdictions to address obesity

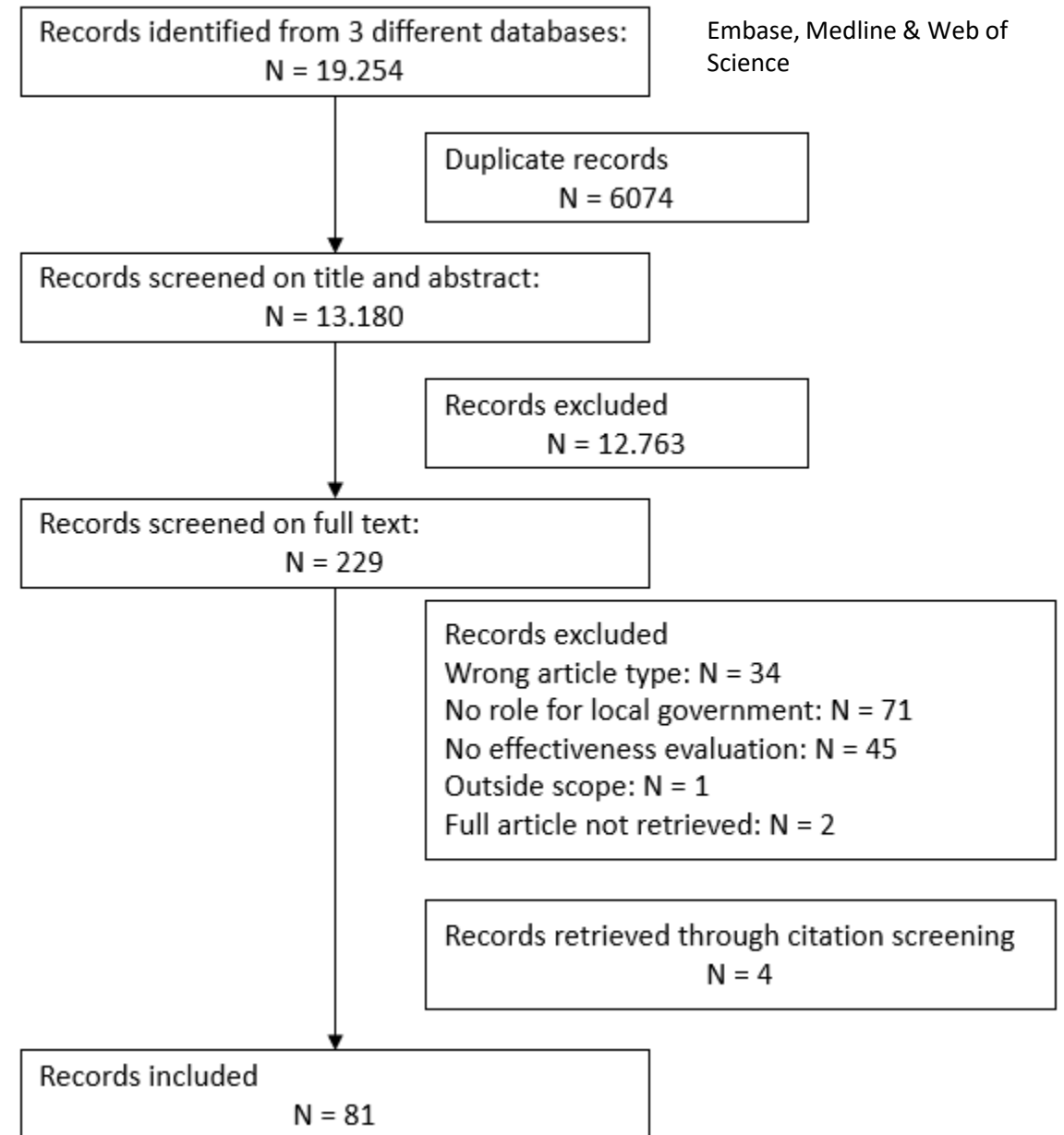


## **BUT**

- Jurisdiction typically narrower compared to national governments
- Expertise and capacity to effectively address obesity = ?
- Budget allocation?

# AIM

- Conducting a scoping review
- Identify actions/policies with a role for local governments
- In high income countries
- Evaluation of effectiveness in influencing diet and physical activity behaviours



# WHY?



# RESULTS



- Actions & policies mainly focused on physical activity and dietary behaviour
- No policies or actions found specifically targeting sedentary behaviour
- Not all actions were effective

## Dietary behaviour

### Effective

- Taxation of sugar-sweetened beverages
- Restriction of new fast food outlets
- Regulations of food offered in public settings

### Not effective or partially effective

- Calorie labelling in restaurants
- Corner store conversions

## Physical activity

### Effective

- Park renovations
- Afterschool physical activity programs
- Land-use and transportation planning policies

### Not effective or partially effective

- Free fare public transportation
- Proximity of recreational facilities or parks

# CONCLUSION

- Highlights a clear potential role of local governments to contribute to obesity prevention
- Through targeted actions.
- Not all actions/policies are transferable across local government jurisdictions
- Longer follow-up for some programs/actions might be needed to truly estimate the effect

# Acknowledgements

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*A joint action for the implementation of best practices and research results  
on Healthy Lifestyle for the health promotion and prevention of non-  
communicable diseases and risk factors*







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# THANK YOU

